



USE IT BEFORE YOUR WORK IS FINISHED. Studio is an engineering coach, not a grader or an instructor approval system. You decide what to change and why.

01 | TWO ROOMS, ONE ENGINEERING WORKFLOW

The rooms work together. Discuss an engineering concern, examine the saved evidence behind it, then return to the same conversation.

ENGINEERING REVIEW ROOM · DISCUSS	Talk with the Review Board; ask questions, challenge its interpretation, and explain decisions.
ENGINEERING EVIDENCE ROOM · INSPECT	Browse saved team evidence and findings; inspect sources before deciding what to change.

SWITCH FREELY Changing rooms does not close your review or update the snapshot attached to its conversation.

02 | YOUR NORMAL PATH

You can get useful coaching on draft estimates, requirements, risks, architecture, PRs, and other incomplete work.

1 GET READY	Sign in. In My Team, confirm your own GitHub identity is linked and the team repository is verified.
2 PUSH YOUR DRAFT	Commit and push what you want reviewed. Studio cannot see files that are only on your computer.
3 START A REVIEW	In Review Room, check the phase; select Board Review or choose Other review options for a Focused Review.
4 DISCUSS AND INSPECT	Respond naturally; inspect sources in Evidence Room or use review-specific evidence controls.
5 IMPROVE AND VERIFY	Decide what to change, work with your team, and verify improvements before pushing new commits.
6 REVIEW AGAIN	Select Start another Board Review or create another appropriate review. Earlier discussions remain in history.

03 | CHOOSE AMONG THREE REVIEW TYPES

Choose by the question you want answered—not by whether the artifact is finished. You may change the topic during the conversation.

BOARD REVIEW Let the Review Board choose a high-value question for the selected phase. Good for a broad check of your current engineering work.

EXAMPLE *"We are in A2. What should our team defend or improve before implementation?"*

FOCUSED REVIEW Choose a particular artifact, decision, estimate, risk, PR, architecture choice, or AI-use issue. Find it under Other review options.

EXAMPLE *"I am drafting our estimates. Are the task breakdown, assumptions and testing effort reasonable?"*

REVIEW FINDINGS Choose one to three existing Review Board findings under Other review options, or open a concern in Evidence Room. Understand, challenge, accept/defer, or plan resolution.

EXAMPLE *"Why was verification ownership flagged? What evidence would address this concern?"*



YOUR REVIEW IS A CONVERSATION. You are not taking a test or filling out a fixed sequence of answers. You can ask for coaching at any point.

04 | ASK ANYTHING—AND CHANGE THE SUBJECT

A Review Board opening question is a starting point, not a restriction. You may steer the discussion to a new engineering question, even if it differs from what the reviewer was asking.

- **Redirect naturally.** “Before I answer that, can you look at how we estimated testing and integration?” The reviewer should respond to your new question within the frozen repository context.
- **Ask for guidance.** “I do not know how to approach this. What should I examine first?” You can also use Explain this and show me how.
- **Challenge with evidence.** “That item is in a different file. Can you examine it and reconsider the finding?” A REVIEW interpretation can be challenged; a frozen snapshot cannot be rewritten.
- **Say what you know and what is missing.** Uncertainty is useful information. Identify evidence you would gather next instead of pretending to know.
- **Reason beyond implementation details.** Discuss assumptions, tradeoffs, consequences, constraints, ownership, and conditions under which your decision would change.
- **Do not optimize for agreement.** Engineering meaning and independent judgment matter more than polished wording or grammar.

BUTTONS IN THE CONVERSATION Explain this and show me how requests coaching; Build my recommendation helps structure a position when you are actually ready to make a consequential decision.

05 | A STRONG ENGINEERING RESPONSE

The Review Board is looking for a defensible engineering rationale, not just the appearance of a correct answer. Use these elements when they matter to the decision.

- **Position.** Your recommendation—or why you are not ready.
- **Evidence.** Repository sources and reasoning supporting your position.
- **Boundary.** Important uncertainty, missing evidence, or limits of authority.
- **Consequence.** Residual risks and the tradeoffs you are accepting.
- **Conditions.** Guardrails, constraints, or preconditions for proceeding.
- **Ownership.** Who will follow through and how it will be verified.
- **Change trigger.** What new evidence or event would cause you to revise, reject, lift, or close the decision.

06 | YOUR CURRENT RECOMMENDATION IS REVISABLE

A recommendation communicates where your engineering judgment stands at this point in time. It is not an irrevocable commitment, an instructor grade, or a substitute for evidence.

NOT READY YET	Keep reasoning; identify missing evidence or authority.
CONTINUE	Proceed on the current path.
CONTINUE WITH CONDITIONS	Proceed only within explicit conditions or guardrails.
HOLD / DEFER	Pause the relevant decision or work until uncertainty is reduced.
REJECT THIS PATH	Recommend a different engineering direction.
REQUEST EVIDENCE / ESCALATE	The decision exceeds current evidence or authority; obtain more input.

NOT THE SAME AS COMMITTING A current recommendation can change. Use the later recommendation action when you can explain and defend a consequential position.



WHAT THE STUDIO KNOWS MATTERS. A repository snapshot records evidence at a particular checkpoint. The Review Board may interpret that evidence, but cannot rewrite history.

07 | UNDERSTAND EVIDENCE AND FINDINGS

These terms distinguish what the repository actually showed from what the Review Board concluded. This distinction matters when you disagree with a finding.

FACT	Frozen, repository-derived evidence. A review does not retroactively change it.
REVIEW FINDING	A challengeable interpretation of FACT; discuss, challenge, resolve, accept/defer, or seek correction.
STRENGTH	Evidence-supported work that is already defensible.
EQUIVALENT EVIDENCE	Different file or artifact form that serves the required engineering purpose.
STARTER SCAFFOLD	Provided structure or template; not proof that the team performed the work.
COVERAGE	How much expected or equivalent current-phase evidence is visible. Not a grade.

08 | INSPECT, DISCUSS, CHALLENGE, OR RESOLVE

Review Board findings are prompts for investigation. Inspect the original source, ask for a better explanation, and challenge weak interpretations before deciding what to change.

- **Inspect cited source.** Open the frozen artifact already attached to the concern.
- **Find supporting evidence.** Search the same frozen snapshot for relevant or equivalent evidence; search is bounded and not exhaustive.
- **Discuss / Challenge.** Ask for explanation or dispute a finding using specific supporting evidence.
- **Help me resolve this.** Ask for practical engineering coaching on what to improve next.
- **Closure is not automatic.** Only authoritative corrected or resolved findings close. Confirmed concerns, evidence disputes, accepted risks, and deferred findings can remain open.
- **Later work is not old evidence.** A new commit, inspected source, search, recommendation, or finished review cannot change what the earlier frozen checkpoint contained.

EVIDENCE INDICATORS An evidence-area count of zero does not prove that no Review Board concerns exist. Evidence coverage is not a course grade. Missing attributable activity alone does not prove nonparticipation.

09 | CHECKPOINTS, COMMITS, AND HISTORY

Each review captures—or safely reuses—frozen evidence for the selected phase and repository revision. The conversation remains tied to that snapshot even after your team pushes more work.

- **GitHub records the version history.** Use GitHub for exact commits, branches, pull requests, and required tags.
- **Review History records coaching sessions.** Return to earlier engineering discussions and their original evidence.
- **Same commit may mean same evidence.** Starting a new review without repository changes can reuse the existing frozen snapshot.
- **Course checkpoints are separate.** A required Git tag or instructor phase-gate submission is not replaced by a developmental Studio review.

10 | SELECTED REVIEW VERSUS LATEST EVIDENCE ROOM SNAPSHOT

An old review's FACT is fixed. Engineering Evidence Room can show the latest saved phase evidence, which may be newer than the selected review.

- **Check the snapshot and commit.** Do not assume that newer Evidence Room content was available to an earlier Review Board.
- **Use original review evidence when necessary.** If snapshots differ, follow the review-specific original-evidence action to inspect what the older review actually used.
- **Switching rooms does not finish a conversation.** Keep your reply in its selected review; unsent drafts belong to that review and browser session.



KEEP CONTROL OF YOUR WORK. Multiple reviews can accumulate over the semester. You choose which conversation is on screen, and you retain responsibility for your decisions.

11 | REVIEW STATUS AND NEXT ACTIONS

You can view one review at a time, but several reviews may remain open. Finished reviews are preserved for reference rather than deleted.

CURRENTLY VIEWING	The single review displayed right now; others may also be open.
OPEN	Resume the same conversation against its original frozen snapshot.
FINISHED	Read-only. Still accessible in Review History; not instructor approval or a phase-gate pass.
BROWSE ALL REVIEWS	Return to older open or finished sessions. Check their commit and snapshot.
START ANOTHER REVIEW	After verified changes are committed and pushed, start another review for newer evidence.

12 | FAST TROUBLESHOOTING

Most problems have a specific next step. If an action fails or the result is uncertain, first check what Studio already saved before retrying.

Wrong GitHub account	My Team → Change linked GitHub account.
GitHub authorization required	Personal owner or GitHub organization owner/admin must authorize access.
Setup Step 1 done, Step 2 pending	Use Check & verify repository access.
Verified repo but you cannot start	Verify your personal GitHub identity and selected phase.
Finding seems wrong	Challenge with evidence; use Review Findings for existing concerns.
0% / thin evidence	May indicate starter scaffold or missing team-created work—not necessarily a broken link.
Old review seems stale	Expected. Push your work and start another review for a newer checkpoint.
An open review already exists	Resume it if you want that same conversation and snapshot.
Not sure what to say	Ask the Review Board or choose Explain this and show me how.
Start / send may have failed	Check the selected review, history, and conversation before trying again.
Page repeatedly slow	Retry once; note the page, time, action and error message for your instructor. Do not share passwords, tokens or private review text.

13 | SAFE USE OF DIALOGS, DRAFTS, AND HELP

Interface help is separate from engineering coaching. Use Help for navigation without calling an AI reviewer; use the Review Board for engineering questions.

- **Dialog keyboard behavior.** Tab and Shift+Tab stay within open Help, artifact, challenge, or exit dialogs; Escape closes through the existing close action and restores usable focus.
- **Closing is not cancellation.** Escape does not finish a review; closing a submitted challenge dialog does not cancel its pending request.
- **Your words remain yours.** Button-triggered instructions are recorded as review actions rather than attributed as student-authored text. Unsent drafts remain private to their original review and browser session; optional review context and other concerns remain secondary to the current conversation.

MY TEAM SHORTCUT If My Team already says Verified team repository, do not reconnect the team repo. Confirm your own GitHub identity is linked, then return to Engineering Review Room.

BEST HABIT Treat the Review Board like a demanding senior engineer: ask, inspect, question, admit uncertainty, and make the final engineering decision yours.